

Yuxuan Chen

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EDUCATION

Master of Science, Computer Science

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Advisor: Mariana Silva

Aug 2024 – Expected May 2026

Cumulative GPA: 3.96/4

Bachelor of Science, Mathematics & Computer Science

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Bronze Tablet Award

Aug 2020 – May 2024

Cumulative GPA: 3.98/4

PUBLICATIONS

- 2026 **Yuxuan Chen**, Chenyan Zhao, Jacob Levine, Kangyu Feng, Max Fowler, Mariana Silva. *On Generating and Validating Erroneous Examples in CS1 using LLMs*. To appear in Artificial Intelligence in Education: 27th International Conference (AIED 2026).
- 2026 **Yuxuan Chen**, Siegfried Eggl, Abdussalam Alawini, Mariana Silva, Max Fowler, Abhishek Umrawal, Melkior Ornik. *WIP: Low Effort, High Grades? Benchmarking LLMs on Various Engineering Assignments*. To appear in Proceedings of the 2026 American Society for Engineering Education Annual Conference and Exposition (ASEE 2026).
- 2026 **Yuxuan Chen**, Chenyan Zhao, Kangyu Feng, Junyu Zhang, Vedan Malhotra, Mariana Silva. *Exploring LLMs for Generating Erroneous Examples in CS1*. In Proceedings of the 57th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education (SIGCSE TS 2026).
- 2025 **Yuxuan Chen**, Chenyan Zhao, Kangyu Feng, Mattox A. Beckman, and Mariana Silva. *A Complete Redesign of CS1 for Engineering Students*. In Proceedings of the 2025 American Society for Engineering Education Annual Conference and Exposition (ASEE 2025).
- 2025 Chenyan Zhao, **Yuxuan Chen**, Kangyu Feng, Geoffrey L Herman, Matthew West, and Mariana Silva. *Implementing a Tool for Structured Roles in Hybrid Collaborative Learning Environments*. In Proceedings of the 2025 American Society for Engineering Education Annual Conference and Exposition (ASEE 2025).
- 2025 Mohammed Hassan, **Yuxuan Chen**, Paul Denny, and Craig Zilles. *On Teaching Novices Computational Thinking by Utilizing Large Language Models Within Assessments*. In Proceedings of the 56th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education (SIGCSE TS 2025).
- 2024 Craig Zilles, Chenyan Zhao, **Yuxuan Chen**, Evan Michael Matthews, and Matthew West. *A Case for Bayesian Grading*. In Proceedings of the 2024 on ACM Virtual Global Computing Education Conference (SIGCSE Virtual 2024).

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant | Siebel School of Computing and Data Science, UIUC

Aug 2024 – Present

- Redesigned the curriculum for a large-scale CS1 course (~1,000 students/year), integrating programming fundamentals with real-world engineering applications.

- Conducted thematic analysis of novice learners' interactions with an LLM-based chatbot to explore how LLMs support the development of computational thinking.
- Developing and evaluating a framework to automatically generate erroneous code examples using LLMs across CS1 topics.
- Benchmarking LLM performance on authentic assignments across multiple engineering courses to identify strengths and weaknesses across problem types.

Undergraduate Research Assistant | *Department of Mathematics, UIUC*

May 2021 – May 2022

- Constructed knot diagrams using SnapPy to support current theorem of the computational complexity of Khovanov Homology.
- Calculated differentials of chain complexes of knots in finite field $\mathbb{Z}/2$ using Python and Pari/GP.
- Generated generalized Choi matrices for Depolarizing/Werner-Holevo Channels using Python.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant | *UIUC CS 357 Numerical Methods I, Champaign, IL*

Jan 2026 – Present

Course Assistant | *UIUC CS 357 Numerical Methods I, Champaign, IL*

Jan 2022 – May 2024

- Assisted over 2,000 students across 5 semesters (~400 per semester) in learning scientific computing and numerical methods including floating points, Taylor series, optimization, and PCA using Python.
- Maintained the official course website by updating lecture notes and course logistics using Ruby Jekyll.
- Answered conceptual/coding questions in lecture sessions, group activities, and office hours.
- Received the **Outstanding Course Assistant Award** for Fall 2023 for excellence in teaching and student support.

Course Assistant | *UIUC CS 519 Scientific Visualization, Champaign, IL*

May 2023 – Aug 2023

Course Assistant | *UIUC CS 124 Intro to Computer Science, Champaign, IL*

Jan 2021 – Dec 2021

ENTREPRENEURSHIP & LEADERSHIP

Co-founder | *AristAI, Inc., Champaign, IL*

Oct 2023 – April 2026

- Led a team to develop AI-powered solutions to improve student learning and content accessibility.
- Awarded \$10,000 prize in the 2024 Cozad New Venture Challenge.

Vice President | *Chinese Engineering Student Association*

Jul 2022 – Jul 2023

INTERNSHIP

Software Engineer Intern | *PrairieLearn, Inc., Champaign, IL*

May 2025 – Aug 2025

- Developed randomized, auto-graded Calculus I questions in PrairieLearn.

Frontend Developer Intern | *EnterpriseWorks, UIRP, Champaign, IL*

May 2022 – Dec 2022

- Built custom websites for Cache Energy, Ensaras Inc., Editekk LLC, and GarboCarbo.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Program Committee Member

- SIGCSE TS 2026
- SIGCSE TS 2025

Session Moderator

- ASEE 2025

SELECTED HONORS & AWARDS

- UIUC University Honors - Bronze Tablet Award **(Top 3%)**, 2024
- UIUC Outstanding Course Assistant Award, 2023
- UIUC Mrs. E. J. Hoover Mathematical Scholar, 2023
- UIUC Edmund J. James Scholar, 2022-2024

SKILLS

Programming: Python, Java, C++, C, R

Web Development: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, TypeScript, React

Databases: SQL, MongoDB, Neo4j

Tools: Git, LaTeX, AWS

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent, TOEFL 118)